MEETING MINUTES

Meridian Valley Foundation, Spring Donor Reception Planning

Date	Tuesday, March 3, 2026
Time	10:00 AM to 10:05 AM
Location	Zoom
Participants	Dana Whitcombe, Priya Ramanathan, Marcus Oyelaran, Jordan Lee

Executive Summary

The team settled the plan for the spring donor reception on Thursday, April 23, from 6:00 to 8:30 PM at Castellane Gallery, for up to 160 guests. Dana approved the venue contract and chose Lumenhall Catering. The projected cost is about **$14,720, under the $15,000 approved budget**. The venue hold expires April 10, so the contract will be signed this week.

Guest List

The list stands at 140 names: major donors, the board, and the 12 new monthly givers from the fall campaign. Priya proposed a cap of 160 so the room does not feel crowded, and Dana agreed.

- Still missing: corporate sponsors, pending two contact lists.
- Final list due to Jordan on **Friday, March 13**.

Venue

Castellane Gallery is holding Thursday, April 23, 6:00 to 8:30 PM. The rental is $4,200 for the evening, including gallery staff for setup and teardown, with half due as a deposit on signing.

- The hold **expires April 10**. Dana approved signing.
- Jordan will route the contract to Dana and has scheduled the signature for Thursday, March 5.

Catering

Two quotes were compared. Lumenhall Catering quoted $62 per guest for heavy appetizers and a wine bar; the other caterer quoted $71 and could not provide a wine bar. Priya noted that Lumenhall catered last year's board dinner and was well received. Dana chose Lumenhall.

- Marcus will confirm the menu, including vegetarian and gluten-free options.
- Final headcount is due to the caterer on April 9.

Program

Dana will give a five-minute welcome. A scholarship student from the arts scholarship cohort will speak for three minutes; Priya will confirm her this week (name to be confirmed). There will be no live auction: Dana wants the evening to read as a thank-you, not an ask. Pledge cards will be on the tables.

Invitations

Jordan will reuse last year's design. Email invitations go out Monday, March 16, and printed invitations go to the mail house the same day. RSVPs close April 2.

Budget

Projected cost

Item	Amount
Venue rental	$4,200
Catering, 160 guests at $62	$9,920
Printing	$600
Total	$14,720

Action Items

Owner	Action	Deadline
Priya Ramanathan	Send the final guest list to Jordan	Friday, March 13
Marcus Oyelaran	Send the venue contract to Jordan for routing	Before Thursday, March 5
Jordan Lee	Route the venue contract to Dana for signature	Thursday, March 5
Marcus Oyelaran	Confirm the menu and dietary options with Lumenhall Catering	TBD
Priya Ramanathan	Confirm the student speaker and her name	This week
Jordan Lee	Send email invitations and deliver printed invitations to the mail house	Monday, March 16
Marcus Oyelaran	Give the caterer the final headcount	Thursday, April 9

Prepared by Jordan Lee, Executive Assistant, March 3, 2026